ROUEN, FRANCE

Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen: Masterpieces

Twenty works at the Musée des Beaux-Arts, from changing weather to portraits and invented encounters with the past.



Monet's cathedral fills the picture almost to its edges. Pissarro's bridge remains a route through a city of smoke, traffic and evening light. Both represent Rouen, but they assign it different scales of attention: one holds a façade close, the other gives urban movement a broader field.

The Musée des Beaux-Arts selection extends well beyond images of the city. Portraits ask how clothing and posture identify people; large historical and mythological scenes distribute authority or violence through a setting. Delaroche's imprisoned Joan of Arc is especially useful for distinguishing a compelling image from a reliable record of an event. These twenty works reward that distinction between what is convincingly painted and what is historically established.

Artline selected these works from documented museum holdings. The selection is independent of the museum, and individual works may be on loan or off display. Dates and attributions retain the qualifications in the linked records.

Explore this selection in Artline

See the selected works alongside books and events from their period, or compare when the artists lived. The books and events provide context, not evidence of direct influence. Works without confirmed dates remain in this guide.

Artworks in context Who lived when?

artlines.org/guides/beaux-arts-rouen

The selection · 20

1. Hill Path in Sunlight
   Alfred Sisley · 1891
2. Male Academy Study, Seated and Seen from Behind
   Théodore Géricault · 1816
3. Portrait of Jacques-Émile Blanche
   John Singer Sargent · c. 1886
4. Madame Aymon, Known as La Belle Zélie
   Jean-Auguste-Dominique Ingres · 1806
5. Venus and Cupid
   Lavinia Fontana · 1592
6. Portrait of a Carabinier
   Théodore Géricault · 1814
7. Burial of a Sailor in a Village in La Manche
   August Hagborg · 1911
8. Diomedes Devoured by His Horses
   Gustave Moreau · 1865
9. Joan of Arc III and Questioned in Prison
   Paul Delaroche · 1824
10. Rouen Cathedral: The Portal and Albane Tower, Grey Weather
    Claude Monet · 1894
11. The Justice of Trajan
    Eugène Delacroix · 1840
12. The Virgin and Blessing Child
    Charles-André van Loo · 1738
13. Lady's Cove, Wales
    Alfred Sisley · 1897
14. The Marriage of Cupid and Psyche
    François Boucher · 1744
15. Pont Boieldieu, Rouen: Sunset, Misty Weather
    Camille Pissarro · 1896
16. The Church at Moret in Full Sunlight
    Alfred Sisley · 1893
17. A Game of Cards
    Judith Leyster · 1633
18. Solemn Mass in Honour of Henry III
    Herman van der Mast · 1575–1604
19. Portrait of Paul Valéry
    Jacques-Emile Blanche · 1923
20. Saint Genevieve before Paris
    Charles Le Brun · c. 1638

01 / 20

Hill Path in Sunlight

Alfred Sisley

1891 · Oil on canvas · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Alfred Sisley. Hill Path in Sunlight. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/alfred-sisley/hill-path-in-sunlight-1891 · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

The rising path gives the small walkers a route and the landscape a direction. Warm grass and scattered trees establish the slope beneath a much larger blue sky. The people are consequential as a measure of the ascent, though their scale keeps the ordinary walk from becoming the only subject of the view.

Object source · Open artwork

02 / 20

Male Academy Study, Seated and Seen from Behind

Théodore Géricault

1816 · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Male 'académie' Seated and Seen from Behind. WikiArt; Théodore Géricault. Proportional resizing and JPEG compression; source frame preserved. · Public domain

The model's back carries most of the information about the pose. Light clarifies its relation to the raised arm while the compressed legs support the seated body below. Without relying on the face, the study makes a bodily position intelligible through pressure, balance and the connections between parts.

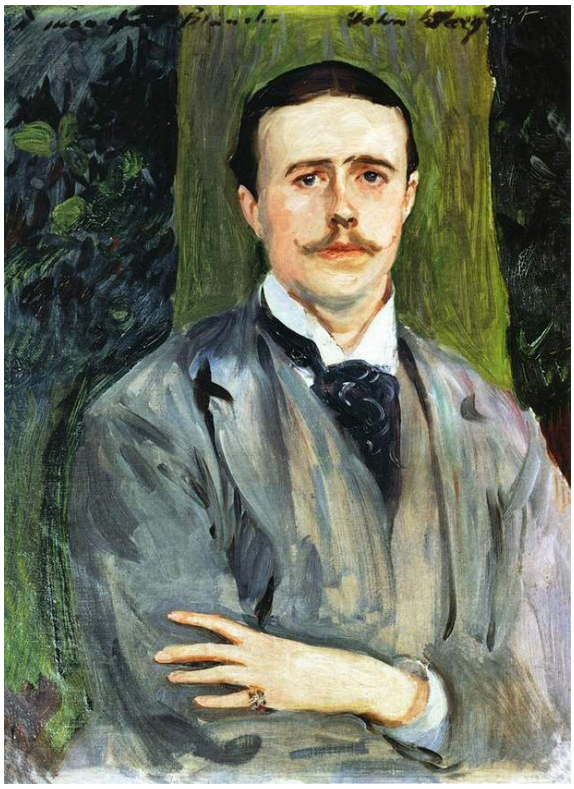
Object source · Open artwork

03 / 20

Portrait of Jacques-Émile Blanche

John Singer Sargent

c. 1886 · Oil on canvas · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



John Singer Sargent. Portrait of Jacques-Emile Blanche. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/john-singer-sargent/portrait-of-jacques-emile-blanche · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

The hand crossing the chest introduces a less rigid element within the grey coat's broad shape. A pale shirt and green background separate the sitter into distinct areas without overfilling the setting. Sargent gives the face sharper attention while allowing the surrounding clothing to remain more broadly handled.

Object source · Open artwork

04 / 20

Madame Aymon, Known as La Belle Zélie

Jean-Auguste-Dominique Ingres

1806 · Oil on canvas · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Jean-Auguste-Dominique Ingres. Portrait of Madame Aymon, La belle Zélie. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/jean-auguste-dominique-ingres/portrait-of-madame-aymon-la-belle-z%C3%A9lie-1806 · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

The oval boundary answers the curls, shawl and the turn of the face with another enclosing curve. Firm edges keep those shapes distinct, giving the likeness an emphatic design. Instead of separating dress from identity, the portrait makes their arrangement part of what allows this particular sitter to register.

Object source · Open artwork

05 / 20

Venus and Cupid

Lavinia Fontana

1592 · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Lavinia Fontana. Venus and Cupid. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

Cupid's approach to Venus's cheek brings the mythological pair into unusually close quarters. Pearls, veil and embroidered fabric receive enough distinction to recall the attention of a portrait. The scene's intimacy comes from proximity and detailed surfaces; it does not require the traditional identification of a particular model to be treated as certain.

Object source · Open artwork

06 / 20

Portrait of a Carabinier

Théodore Géricault

1814 · Oil on canvas · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Portrait of a Carabinier. WikiArt; Théodore Géricault. Proportional resizing and JPEG compression; source frame preserved. · Public domain

The polished breastplate gives the torso a hard surface that contrasts with the living face and hand. The large hat occupies further space beside the soldier, so military equipment remains conspicuous without completely enclosing him. Géricault holds the individual and the professional role together through these different kinds of surface.

Object source · Open artwork

07 / 20

Burial of a Sailor in a Village in La Manche

August Hagborg

1911 · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



August Hagborg. Burial of a Sailor in a Manche Village. Image credit: August Hagborg; Source credit: Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The road allows a funeral to extend beyond one tightly grouped cluster of mourners. Separate villagers belong to the procession at different distances, while the ordinary settlement remains around them. Hagborg locates collective loss within a place people continue to inhabit, rather than isolating mourning from the daily landscape.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 1911.6

08 / 20

Diomedes Devoured by His Horses

Gustave Moreau

1865 · Oil on canvas · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Gustave Moreau. DIOMEDE DEVORE PAR SES CHEVAUX. WikiArt: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt per-object label)

The enormous ruin threatens to outweigh the small figures and horses beneath it. A violent subject is therefore not offered as one immediately legible encounter. Attention must move through architectural scale and dark openings to locate the action, making the setting an active obstacle to a quick reading of the myth.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 931.16.1

09 / 20

Joan of Arc Ill and Questioned in Prison

Paul Delaroche

1824 · Oil on canvas · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Paul Delaroche; WikiArt · Public domain

The cardinal's red robes occupy the cell with a weight that contrasts with Joan's more restricted position. The scene is historical invention: the museum notes that Winchester never visited her in prison. Delaroche uses the imagined encounter to make unequal power visible, not to provide an eyewitness account of an interrogation.

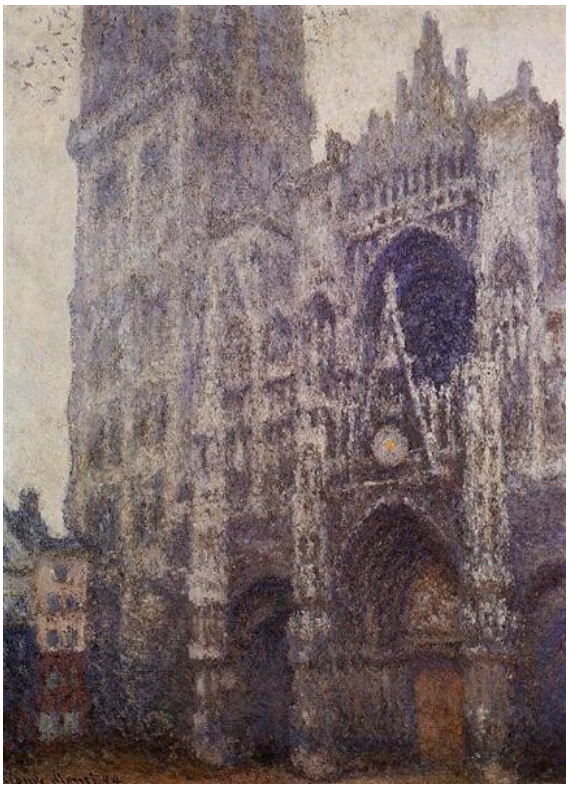
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 982.6.1

10 / 20

Rouen Cathedral: The Portal and Albane Tower, Grey Weather

Claude Monet

1894 · Oil on canvas · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Claude Monet; WikiArt · Public domain

The close crop excludes nearly all the surrounding city, allowing the façade to occupy the painted field. Grey and blue-violet marks turn stone into a record of atmospheric change. The museum dates this canvas 1894, while explaining that the cathedral series was worked on in 1892–1893 and dated later—a useful distinction between a painted view and its inscribed year.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 909.32

11 / 20

The Justice of Trajan

Eugène Delacroix

1840 · Oil on canvas · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Eugène Delacroix. La Justice de Trajan. Image credit: Eugène Delacroix; Source credit: Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Proportional resize and JPEG compression; full source frame retained. · Public domain

The bright horse helps locate Trajan within the crossing gestures, banners and crowd. Authority is presented through a moving, public encounter rather than a ruler alone on a throne. The surrounding figures remain necessary to the image: a judgment has to be enacted before people, not merely declared through the emperor's likeness.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: D.844.1.1

12 / 20

The Virgin and Blessing Child

Charles-André van Loo

1738 · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Шарль Андре Ван Лоо. La Vierge et l'enfant bénissant. Image credit: Charles André van Loo. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The child's raised hand is separated clearly enough from the background to read as a blessing. Mary supports his standing body, joining that ceremonial gesture to a practical relation of care. The small group's closeness makes spiritual authority appear through a dependent child rather than through an isolated, commanding figure.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: SR 53

13 / 20

Lady's Cove, Wales

Alfred Sisley

1897 · Oil on canvas · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Alfred Sisley. Lady’s Cove, Pays de Galles. Image credit: Alfred Sisley; Source credit: https://www.alfredsisley.org/the-complete-works.html?ps=96&pageno=9. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Proportional resize and JPEG compression; full source frame retained. · Public domain

Successive bands of surf describe different distances from the rocks and headland. The coastline remains comparatively firm while the water breaks into changing marks. Sisley uses that contrast to keep movement measurable: waves can alter from moment to moment without making the shore's recession impossible to follow.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 909.1.48

14 / 20

The Marriage of Cupid and Psyche

François Boucher

1744 · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



François Boucher. Le Mariage de l'Amour et Psyché. Image credit: François Boucher. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The figures form an open curve across the clouds, with gaps that prevent the celestial company from becoming a solid crowd. Smaller winged bodies and drapery extend the assembly without giving it an earthly platform. Suspension is part of the design; the spaces between the bodies help the celebration appear unweighted.

Object source · Open artwork

15 / 20

Pont Boieldieu, Rouen: Sunset, Misty Weather

Camille Pissarro

1896 · Oil on canvas · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Camille Pissarro. Le Pont Boieldieu à Rouen, soleil couchant, temps brumeux. Image credit: Camille Pissarro; Source credit: http://mbarouen.fr/fr/oeuvres/le-pont-boieldieu-a-rouen-soleil-couchant-temps-brumeux. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Proportional resize and JPEG compression; full source frame retained. · Public domain

The bridge provides a clear diagonal through smoke and evening haze. People and vehicles remain small marks along that route, connecting the atmospheric view to ordinary traffic. Pissarro makes a working city legible without separating industry from weather: both contribute to the air through which the river and buildings are seen.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: D.2000.1.1

16 / 20

The Church at Moret in Full Sunlight

Alfred Sisley

1893 · Oil on canvas · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Alfred Sisley. L'Eglise de Moret (plein soleil). Image credit: Alfred Sisley; Source credit: The Yorck Project (2002) 10.000 Meisterwerke der Malerei (DVD-ROM), distributed by DIRECTMEDIA Publishing GmbH. ISBN : 3936122202 .. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Proportional resize and JPEG compression; full source frame retained. · Public domain

Yellow stone and blue-violet shadow divide the same church into areas of different temperature. Small awnings and figures locate it within a street, while the crop gives its walls considerable scale. The building provides a fixed arrangement on which the changing conditions of sunlight can become conspicuous.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 909.1.47

17 / 20

A Game of Cards

Judith Leyster

1633 · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Judith Leyster. A Game of Cards. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The woman in red turns toward the space outside the players' circle, while another participant makes cards visible. Their gathering is already underway, yet these gestures open it to an additional observer. Leyster gives sociability several directions at once; no single gaze explains all the relations around the barrel-table.

Object source · Open artwork

18 / 20

Solemn Mass in Honour of Henry III

Herman van der Mast

1575–1604 · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Herman van der Mast. Messe solennelle en l'honneur d'Henri III. Image credit: David.Monniaux; Own work. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Messe_solennelle_en_pr%C3%A9sence_dHenri_III_IMG_7446.jpg. CC0 (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/zero/1.0/). Full-frame resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC0

Kneeling and standing groups take different positions within the church, using posture and clothing to distinguish their roles. Architecture leads toward the ceremony farther inside and gives the assembly a common order. The scene can accommodate many participants without requiring each to become an individually isolated portrait.

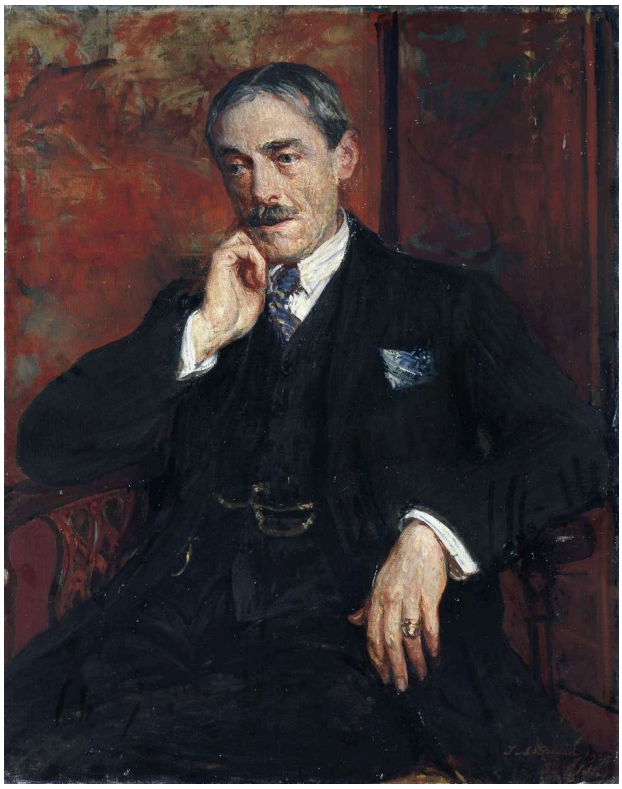
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: SR 89

19 / 20

Portrait of Paul Valéry

Jacques-Emile Blanche

1923 · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Jacques-Émile Blanche. Portrait de Paul Valéry. Image credit: Jacques-Émile Blanche. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The hand against Valéry's cheek gives the head a physical support and breaks the upright formality of the seated pose. A patterned red ground surrounds the pale face. The gesture may suggest thought, but cannot reveal its content; the portrait's strength lies in a particular arrangement rather than an invented account of the writer's mind.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 1930.1.2

20 / 20

Saint Genevieve before Paris

Charles Le Brun

c. 1638 · Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen



Charles Le Brun. Sainte Geneviève devant Paris. Image credit: Charles Le Brun. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Resized and JPEG-compressed; selected source frame preserved. · Public domain

The saint's reading takes place beneath an angel while Paris remains visible at a distance. That relation connects an apparently secluded devotional act to a city beyond it. Light concentrates on the figures, but the urban setting keeps their significance from remaining wholly private or confined to the immediate foreground.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 975.4.45

Take one comparison into the city

After studying Monet's cathedral or Pissarro's bridge, a present-day view can clarify how much each painting selects. It will not reproduce the artist's position, weather or historical surroundings exactly. Confirm current museum displays separately, especially if one work is the main reason for a visit.

Further reading

Impressionism: A Centenary Exhibition

Anne Dayez, Michel Hoog and Charles S. Moffett · Read online or download · English

The Metropolitan Museum's Impressionism: A Centenary Exhibition provides entries and historical essays for the painters represented here by Monet, Pissarro and Sisley. Read it alongside the contrasting views of Rouen and the Seine.

Museum website · Official collection guide

Sources and visitor information checked: 2026-10-12